SABRINA FAJARDO
sfajardo@uchicago.edu | (414)-216-8292

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
B.S. in Computer Science & B.A. in Cognitive Science, expected June 2028
Minor in Media Arts and Design| GPA: **3.63/4.00**

EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago's Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) Lab, Chicago, IL
Research Assistant Intern: In-Home Child Robot Interaction, June 2026 – August 2026

- Deployed robots directly to participants' homes, leading live demo sessions and explaining study protocols to families
- Maintained continuous operations for two-week in-person studies by providing around-the-clock technical support and troubleshooting
- Engineered secure data pipelines by extracting hardware logs from Raspberry Pis and organizing datasets into Box
- Performed data cleaning and ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) processes on Qualtrics datasets for quantitative analysis, conducted qualitative coding across multiple projects, and implemented ongoing codebase adjustments

Research Assistant Intern: Human-Robot Rapport Study, June 2025 – August 2025

- Synthesized 15+ HRI and psychology papers to inform experimental design, validate measures, and discover different robot dialogue strategies
- Prompt-engineered LLM-driven robot dialogue using extensive fine-tuning and programmed experimental logic in Kotlin to adhere to condition constraints
- Redesigned the front-end interface by improving HTML face animations, goal visualizations, and screen transitions to optimize the user experience (UX) across 55+ experimental sessions

South Milwaukee School District Information Technology, South Milwaukee, WI
IT Intern/Youth Apprentice, January 2024 – September 2024

- Resolved hardware and software issues across six school buildings, troubleshooting up to 5 devices weekly to ensure staff productivity
- Executed major infrastructure upgrades by installing access points and reorganizing 50+ cables in the Main Distribution Frame (MDF) room to enhance network security and connectivity
- Earned the Occupational Skills Proficiency Certification in IT after completing 450+ hours of technical support and system administration

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Undergraduate Student Government, University of Chicago
Committee Member, May 2026 - Present

- **Community Service Fund (CSF):** Selected from a competitive applicant pool to evaluate annual allocation requests and project appeals, determining budget distributions for community service organizations
- **Awareness & Prevention Committee:** Co-facilitate harm-reduction workshops for incoming freshmen and manage the campus-wide distribution of physical safety resources

PROJECTS

- **Modified Chess Bot (C):** Programmed an automated bot to evaluate board states and execute competitive moves in a modified chess variant
- **Interactive Card Game (Python):** Collaborated on a team to engineer a playable card game, developing both a Graphical User Interface (GUI) and a Text-based User Interface (TUI)

SKILLS

Languages: Conversational Spanish (Passed UChicago Language Competency Exam)
Programming: Python, C (Proficient) | Java, Javascript, Kotlin, R, HTML (Familiar)
Software & Tools: Microsoft Excel (Certified), Git, Github, Vim, Figma, Makefiles, Linux